

B.Ed. 1st Semester — Course 1.1.1 (1st Half)

Childhood and Growing up: Development and its Characteristics

Question Bank (2020–2024) with Model Answers

Repeated questions are listed once with all years noted. Group A ≈ 50 words, Group B ≈ 150 words (point form), Group C ≈ 300 words.

GROUP A — 2 Marks Each (any 5 asked, ~50 words)

1. What is Schema? (2020, 2022, 2024)

A schema is a mental framework that helps a person organize and understand information. It is built from past experience and learning. Schemas help us make sense of new situations quickly and guide how we think, learn, and behave.

2. What do you mean by mental substitution? (2020, 2021)

Mental substitution means representing objects, actions, or experiences in the mind through symbols, images, or words instead of doing them physically. It shows the child's growing ability to think symbolically, which is the base of imagination and later abstract thinking.

3. Mention any two characteristics of personality trait. (2020, 2021, 2023)

- A trait stays fairly stable and consistent across time and situations.
- Traits can be measured in degree — people differ in how much of a trait (like shyness or confidence) they show.

4. What is meant by the stage of "Storm and Stress"? (2021, 2022)

This term (by G. Stanley Hall) describes adolescence as a period of emotional ups and downs, mood swings, conflict with parents, and risk-taking. It happens due to fast physical, hormonal, and psychological changes during teenage years.

5. What is Babbling? (2021, 2022)

Babbling is an early stage of language development, seen around 6 months of age, where infants repeat simple sounds like "ba-ba" or "da-da". It is a pre-speech stage that later helps in forming real words.

6. What is Assimilation? (2021, 2022)

Assimilation (Piaget's term) means fitting new information into an existing schema without changing that schema. For example, a child who knows "dog" may call a cat a "dog" too, using an old mental category for a new experience.

7. Mention any four principles of Development. (2021, 2022)

- Development follows a fixed, predictable order.
- It moves from general to specific (head to toe, centre to sides).
- Development is a continuous, lifelong process.
- It results from both heredity and environment together.

8. What are the components of language? (2020, 2023)

The main parts of language are: Phonology (sounds), Morphology (word formation), Syntax (grammar/sentence order), Semantics (meaning of words), and Pragmatics (using language correctly in social situations).

9. Mention any two differences between Growth and Development. (2021, 2024)

Growth is quantitative — it means physical change like height and weight, and it stops after a certain age. Development is qualitative — it means change in skills and behavior, and it continues throughout life.

10. What is meant by Pre-gang stage? (2020)

The pre-gang stage is seen in early childhood (about 5–7 years) when children start forming small, loose play groups with no fixed rules or leader. It is the beginning of making friends and playing in groups.

11. What is Syntax? (2020)

Syntax is the set of rules that decide how words are arranged to form correct phrases and sentences in a language. It controls word order and sentence structure so that speech makes sense.

12. What is Libido? (2020)

In Freud's theory, libido is the psychic and sexual energy that drives human behavior and the search for pleasure. It powers the Id and plays a key role in personality development through Freud's psychosexual stages.

13. What is ID and Superego? (2022)

The Id is the instinctive part of the mind that wants immediate pleasure and satisfaction. The Superego is the moral part of the mind, formed from family and society's rules, that pushes a person to act ethically.

14. Write two causes of individual difference. (2022)

- Heredity: genetic factors passed from parents affect physical and mental traits.
- Environment: upbringing, education, and life experiences shape a person's unique abilities and personality.

15. Mention the two functions of "Ego". (2024)

The ego tests reality, helping a person tell the difference between inner wishes and the outside world. It also controls defense mechanisms, balancing the demands of the Id and Superego to reduce anxiety.

16. What is "Para-Linguistic" development in Communication? (2024)

Para-linguistic development means the non-verbal parts of speech, like tone, pitch, speed, and pauses. These add feeling and meaning to spoken words and make communication clearer and more effective.

17. What do you mean by "Cognition"? (2024)

Cognition means mental processes like thinking, reasoning, remembering, and understanding. It is how the brain takes in information, processes it, and uses it to learn, decide, and solve problems.

18. Mention two basic roles of "family" in child rearing practices. (2024)

The family gives emotional support and a sense of safety to the child. It also teaches social values, manners, and cultural norms, helping the child grow into a well-adjusted member of society.

19. What is "Sociometry"? (2024)

Sociometry is a method used to study social relationships within a group. It shows who is liked or left out, helping identify popular members and those who feel isolated, so teachers can improve group harmony.

20. Write any four emotional characteristics of early childhood. (2023)

- Emotions are strong but short-lasting.
- Moods change quickly.

- Feelings are shown openly, without hiding.
- Fear, anger, and jealousy appear easily over small things.

21. What is meant by self-concept? (2023)

Self-concept is how a person sees and understands themselves — their abilities, looks, and worth. It develops through personal experience and feedback from others, and it affects confidence and behavior.

22. Write any two importance of individual difference in Education. (2023)

- It helps teachers plan lessons suited to each student's ability and pace.
- It helps identify a student's strengths and weaknesses for better guidance and career advice.

23. What is 'Accommodation'? (2023)

Accommodation (Piaget's term) means changing an existing schema, or forming a new one, when new information does not fit the old mental structure. It helps a person adjust to new experiences.

24. Mention the stages of cognitive development as proposed by Piaget. (2023)

Piaget gave four stages: Sensorimotor (0–2 yrs), Preoperational (2–7 yrs), Concrete Operational (7–11 yrs), and Formal Operational (11 yrs onward). Each stage shows a different way of thinking as the child grows.

GROUP B — 5 Marks Each (any 3 asked, ~150 words, point form)

1. Describe the stages of moral development as proposed by Kohlberg. (2021, 2022, 2024)

- Kohlberg gave **3 levels**, each with 2 stages, showing how moral thinking grows.
- **Pre-conventional level** (children): right or wrong is decided by fear of punishment or by self-interest.
- **Conventional level**: morality is based on social approval, rules, and duty; the person wants to be seen as "good" and follows the law.
- **Post-conventional level**: morality is based on personal values like justice, fairness, and human rights, even if this goes against written rules.
- Each higher stage shows more mature and independent moral thinking.
- **Educational use**: teachers can use moral dilemmas and group discussion to help students grow in ethical reasoning.

2. Discuss the role of family in growth and development of individuals. (2021, 2023)

- **Physical**: family gives food, shelter, and healthcare needed for growth.
- **Emotional**: love and care from family build trust and confidence.
- **Social**: family teaches language, manners, and social behavior — the child's first socialization.
- **Moral**: parents model right and wrong, shaping the child's values.
- **Intellectual**: talking, reading, and playing with the child boosts early learning.
- **Parenting style** (strict, caring, or neglectful) affects how well the child grows emotionally and socially.
- A stable, loving family builds a confident, well-adjusted person.

3. Discuss in brief the advantages and disadvantages of Projective Test. (2020, 2023)

- **Meaning**: a personality test using unclear pictures (like inkblots), where the person's answers show hidden feelings.

- **Advantages:**
 - Reveals unconscious thoughts not shown in normal talk.
 - Hard to fake, since there is no fixed answer.
 - Gives detailed, personal information.
- **Disadvantages:**
 - Scoring depends on the examiner's judgment, so results can vary.
 - Needs a trained expert and takes a long time.
 - Result reliability can be low.
- Best used along with other tests for a full personality picture.

4. Discuss the role of school and teacher in solving the problems of adolescence. (2021, 2022)

- Adolescence brings stress from studies, identity confusion, and peer pressure.
- Teachers can offer **guidance and counselling** to help students handle these problems.
- A friendly classroom encourages students to talk openly without fear.
- Sports and extra-curricular activities help release stress in a healthy way.
- Teachers should work with parents to notice changes in behavior early.
- Value education and open discussion on personal issues (like identity, relationships) help students feel understood and supported.

5. Write the characteristics of 'Cognitive Development' at adolescence. (2020)

- Adolescents enter Piaget's **formal operational stage**, so they can think about ideas, not just real objects.
- They can form guesses (hypotheses) and reason through problems logically.
- **Metacognition** develops – thinking about one's own thinking.
- They begin to question rules, authority, and abstract ideas like justice.
- A new form of egocentrism appears – feeling "everyone is watching me" (imaginary audience).
- These changes help in planning for the future, career choices, and complex school subjects.

6. Write the effects of poverty on Growth and Development of individuals. (2020)

- **Physical:** poor food and healthcare can cause weak growth and more illness.
- **Cognitive:** lack of books, toys, and good schools limits learning.
- **Emotional:** money stress at home can cause anxiety and low confidence in children.
- **Social:** children may face fewer chances to mix and learn social skills.
- Long-term poverty can affect brain development in early years.
- Support from school and community can reduce some of these harmful effects.

7. Write the characteristics of pre-operational stage of cognitive development as stated by Piaget. (2020)

- This stage is from age 2 to 7 years.
- Children start using **symbols and language**, and enjoy pretend play.
- **Egocentrism:** they find it hard to see things from another person's view.
- **Centration:** they focus on only one feature of a thing at a time.
- They do not yet understand **conservation** (that amount stays same even if shape changes).

- Thinking is **irreversible** – they cannot mentally undo an action.

8. Write the importance of individual differences in education. (2020)

- Helps teachers plan lessons that match each student's ability and speed of learning.
- Helps in spotting gifted students and slow learners for the right support.
- Supports fair testing, instead of judging all students the same way.
- Useful for career and subject guidance based on a student's strengths.
- Supports inclusive education, helping children with special needs learn better.

9. Mention the components of language development. Mention any four differences between growth and development. (2022)

- **Language components:** phonology (sounds), morphology (word forming), syntax (grammar), semantics (meaning), pragmatics (social use).
- **Differences between growth and development:**
 - Growth is quantitative; development is qualitative.
 - Growth stops after maturity; development continues for life.
 - Growth can be measured directly (height, weight); development is judged through behavior and skills.
 - Growth is only a part of development; development is the wider process covering body, mind, emotion, and social life.

10. Discuss the five-factor theory of personality. (2022)

- Also called the **Big Five**, it explains personality using five traits:
 - **Openness** – curiosity, imagination.
 - **Conscientiousness** – discipline, responsibility.
 - **Extraversion** – sociability, energy.
 - **Agreeableness** – kindness, cooperation.
 - **Neuroticism** – emotional instability, anxiety.
- Each trait exists on a scale, and people differ in how much of each they show.
- The theory is well tested across cultures and is useful in education, counselling, and career guidance.

11. What is projective technique? Briefly discuss Rorschach's Ink Blot test. (2022)

- A **projective technique** uses unclear pictures so a person's hidden thoughts and feelings come out in their answers.
- **Rorschach Test:** made by Hermann Rorschach, it uses 10 symmetrical inkblots.
- The person tells what they see in each blot.
- The examiner studies the shape, color, and content of answers to understand personality and emotional state.
- Widely used in clinical psychology, but needs skilled interpretation.

12. Write the general characteristics of growth. (2021)

- Growth follows a fixed, step-by-step pattern in all individuals.
- It moves head-to-toe (cephalocaudal) and centre-to-sides (proximodistal).
- Growth is fast in infancy and adolescence, slower in middle childhood.

- It is quantitative — measured in height, weight, and body size.
- Growth stops after reaching physical maturity, unlike development, which continues for life.

13. Discuss the role of socio-cultural environment in individual difference. (2021)

- Culture and society shape a person through language, customs, and values learnt while growing up.
- Cultural practices affect how a person thinks and behaves morally.
- Family income affects access to education, food, and healthcare, causing growth differences.
- Peer groups, community, and media shape attitudes and interests.
- So, people from different social and cultural backgrounds grow into different personalities, even with similar biology.

14. Mention the characteristics of Emotional development at adolescence. (2024)

- Adolescents feel strong emotions and frequent mood swings due to hormonal changes.
- They build a stronger sense of identity and self-awareness.
- Empathy grows, leading to deeper friendships.
- Emotional control is still developing, so impulsive behavior can happen.
- Support and open talk from teachers and parents help balanced emotional growth.

15. Discuss in brief the advantages and disadvantages of Self-reporting technique. (2024)

- **Meaning:** people share their own feelings and views through questionnaires or interviews.
- **Advantages:**
 - Cheap and easy to use on large groups.
 - Gives direct information about personal feelings.
- **Disadvantages:**
 - People may hide the truth to look good (social desirability).
 - Memory mistakes can affect answers.
 - Some people may lack self-awareness, reducing accuracy.
- Works best combined with other methods like observation.

16. Enumerate the educational significance of Cattell's 16PF theory. (2024)

- Cattell's theory lists 16 personality factors that describe individual differences.
- It helps teachers understand each student's learning style and personality.
- Useful for career and vocational guidance, matching traits to suitable jobs.
- Helps in classroom management by predicting student behavior.
- Useful for grouping students for teamwork and spotting leadership qualities.

17. Briefly describe the stages of "Psycho-social development" as stated by Erikson. (2024)

- Erikson gave **8 stages**, each with a conflict to resolve:
 - Infancy: trust vs. mistrust
 - Early childhood: autonomy vs. shame
 - Preschool: initiative vs. guilt

- School age: industry vs. inferiority
- Adolescence: identity vs. role confusion
- Young adulthood: intimacy vs. isolation
- Adulthood: generativity vs. stagnation
- Old age: integrity vs. despair
- Solving each conflict well leads to healthy personality growth.

18. Discuss the stages of psycho-sexual development as described by Freud. (2023)

- Freud gave **5 stages**, based on where pleasure/energy is focused:
 - **Oral** (0–1 yr): pleasure through the mouth.
 - **Anal** (1–3 yrs): pleasure through bowel control, linked to toilet training.
 - **Phallic** (3–6 yrs): focus on genitals; Oedipus/Electra complex appears.
 - **Latency** (6–puberty): sexual urges rest; focus shifts to school and social skills.
 - **Genital** (puberty onward): mature sexual interest develops.
- Getting "stuck" (fixated) at any stage can affect adult personality.

19. How is the learner's emotional development affected by Deprivation and Disrupted family? (2023)

- Lack of love and care (deprivation), or family breakdown (divorce, death, conflict), can hurt a child's emotional health.
- Children may feel insecure, have low self-esteem, and find it hard to trust others.
- Behavior problems and poor emotional control are common.
- Academic performance often suffers due to lack of home support.
- Long-term effects can include difficulty in social life and mental health issues.
- A caring school environment and counselling can help reduce the damage.

20. What are the responsibilities of teacher and parents regarding language development? (2023)

- **Teachers should:** create a language-rich classroom, encourage reading and discussion, use simple and correct language, and be patient with struggling students.
- **Parents should:** talk and read with the child from infancy, use correct grammar as a model, and provide a stimulating home environment.
- Both should work together to spot and fix any speech delay early.

GROUP C — 10 Marks Each (any 1 asked, ~300 words)

1. Describe briefly the salient characteristics of Cognitive development stages according to Jean Piaget with educational significance. (2024; related: "Discuss Piaget's stages of Cognitive Development, critical comment" – 2022)

Piaget said children build their own knowledge as they grow, moving through four stages of thinking.

- **Sensorimotor stage (0–2 years):** the child learns through senses and movement. Object permanence (knowing a hidden object still exists) develops. *Education:* give infants hands-on, exploratory activities.

- **Preoperational stage (2–7 years):** the child uses language and symbols, and enjoys pretend play, but struggles with logic (egocentrism, no conservation). *Education:* use pictures, stories, and role-play to teach.
- **Concrete Operational stage (7–11 years):** the child thinks logically about real, concrete things – understands conservation, reversibility, and classification. *Education:* use experiments and group activities.
- **Formal Operational stage (11 years onward):** the child can think abstractly, form hypotheses, and reason logically about ideas. *Education:* use debates, discussions, and independent projects.

Critical comment: Piaget's theory is useful for planning age-appropriate teaching, but it has some limits:

- Later research shows some skills (like object permanence) may appear earlier than Piaget thought.
- The fixed age ranges do not always match real children, since development speed can differ.
- The theory gives less importance to the role of social and cultural learning, which Vygotsky's theory highlights more strongly.

Even with these limits, Piaget's stages remain a strong base for understanding how children think and for designing lessons suited to each age group.

2. Discuss the role of family in child rearing practices. (2021, 2022)

The family is the child's first and most important social group, shaping the child's growth in many ways.

- **Physical role:** family provides food, shelter, healthcare, and safety needed for the body to grow well.
- **Emotional role:** love, care, and attachment from family build the child's trust, security, and self-esteem.
- **Social role:** family is the first place a child learns language, manners, and social behavior, preparing them to live in wider society.
- **Moral role:** parents model right and wrong behavior, passing on values and cultural beliefs that shape the child's conscience.
- **Intellectual role:** talking, reading, and playing with the child early on helps build language skills and thinking ability, useful later in school.

Parenting style matters a lot:

- A caring but firm style (authoritative) usually leads to confident, well-behaved children.
- Too much strictness (authoritarian) or too little control (permissive) or neglect can cause behavior and emotional problems.

In short, the family builds the base of a child's personality. A warm, stable, and value-based family helps a child grow into a confident and socially able person, while a troubled or neglecting family can lead to emotional and behavioral difficulties later in life.

3. Discuss the stages of psycho-social development as stated by Erikson (with educational implications). (2021, 2023)

Erik Erikson described eight stages of personality growth across a person's life, each built around one main conflict.

1. **Trust vs. Mistrust (0–1 yr):** babies build trust through steady, loving care. *Implication:* caregivers must be reliable and warm.

2. **Autonomy vs. Shame/Doubt (1–3 yrs):** toddlers try to do things themselves. *Implication:* allow safe independence, avoid over-criticizing.
3. **Initiative vs. Guilt (3–6 yrs):** children start their own activities and play. *Implication:* encourage exploration and creative play.
4. **Industry vs. Inferiority (6–12 yrs):** children build skills through school work. *Implication:* give chances to succeed and praise effort.
5. **Identity vs. Role Confusion (12–18 yrs):** teens search for who they are. *Implication:* schools should support self-discovery through counselling and varied activities.
6. **Intimacy vs. Isolation (young adulthood):** forming close, trusting relationships.
7. **Generativity vs. Stagnation (adulthood):** contributing to family, work, and society.
8. **Integrity vs. Despair (old age):** looking back and feeling satisfied with life.

If a stage's conflict is resolved well, the person gains a healthy quality (like trust or identity); if not, negative traits (like mistrust or confusion) may remain.

Understanding these stages helps teachers and parents give the right kind of support at each age — for example, praising effort in school years, and giving space for identity exploration in the teenage years — so that learners grow into emotionally healthy, well-adjusted individuals.

4. Discuss the trait theory of personality described by Eysenck. / Evaluate the strengths and limitations of Eysenck's trait theory. (2020, 2023)

Hans Eysenck built a trait theory of personality based on biology. He described personality using two main scales, later adding a third:

- **Extraversion–Introversion:** how outgoing or reserved a person is.
- **Neuroticism–Stability:** how emotionally steady or anxious a person is.
- **Psychoticism** (added later): related to tough-mindedness and risk-taking.

He believed these traits come from differences in brain arousal. For example, extraverts have lower natural brain arousal, so they seek excitement from outside; introverts have higher arousal, so they avoid too much stimulation.

Each trait works like a scale, and every person falls somewhere along it, measurable through tests like the Eysenck Personality Questionnaire. Combining the scales gives personality types, such as "stable-extravert" or "neurotic-introvert," each linked to typical behavior patterns.

Strengths:

- Based on biological evidence, giving it strong scientific support.
- Backed by twin studies, showing a genetic link to personality.
- Simple and practical to use in schools and clinics.

Limitations:

- Too simple — reduces personality to only a few traits, missing others like kindness or openness (as in the Five-Factor Model).
- Gives less importance to environment and learning in shaping personality.
- May not fully explain how situations affect behavior.

Despite these weaknesses, Eysenck's theory remains an important and widely used base for understanding individual differences in personality, especially in educational and clinical settings.

5. What are the key sources of stress in adolescence? Why is guidance and counselling important for ethical and positive mental health? (2024)

Adolescence is a time of fast physical, emotional, and social change, which makes teens more prone to stress.

Key sources of stress:

- **Academic pressure:** high expectations and competition in studies.
- **Peer relationships:** pressure to fit in, be accepted, and follow the group.
- **Family conflicts:** clashes with parents and changing expectations at home.
- **Emotional changes:** mood swings, self-consciousness, and confusion about identity.
- **Biological factors:** hormonal changes that increase emotional sensitivity.
- **Social media:** unhealthy comparison, cyberbullying, and fear of missing out.

Why guidance and counselling matter:

- They give teens a safe space to talk about fears and worries.
- They teach coping skills, problem-solving, and good decision-making.
- They build resilience and self-confidence to handle pressure.
- They teach moral reasoning and empathy, helping teens act responsibly and understand the results of their choices.
- Early support from schools and counselors can stop small problems from becoming serious mental health issues.

In conclusion, adolescence brings many kinds of stress from studies, family, peers, and technology. Proper guidance and counselling help teens manage this stress, grow emotionally stable, and develop into responsible, ethical, and well-adjusted adults.

6. What is personality? According to Cattell, how are surface trait and source trait interrelated? Discuss with examples. (2020)

Personality means the stable pattern of thoughts, feelings, and behavior that makes one person different from another, shaping how they act and relate to others.

Raymond Cattell divided personality traits into two levels:

- **Surface traits:** these are behaviors we can directly see, that seem to go together — for example, "sociability" (which includes friendliness, talking a lot, and warmth). They are visible but do not explain why the behavior happens.
- **Source traits:** these are the deeper, hidden traits that actually cause the surface traits, found using a method called factor analysis. Cattell identified 16 such source traits (forming his 16PF theory) — for example, warmth, emotional stability, and dominance.

How they connect:

One or more source traits combine to produce a surface trait. For example:

- The surface trait "sociability" may come from the source traits of warmth and low anxiety together.

- The surface trait "leadership" may come from the source traits of dominance and emotional stability together.

So, source traits are the basic building blocks of personality — fewer in number, but deeper and more stable. Surface traits are their visible, outward result and may change more with the situation.

In short, understanding source traits helps explain why certain surface behaviors appear together, giving a fuller and more scientific picture of personality than simply observing behavior alone.

Compiled from BSAEU B.Ed. 1st Semester question papers: 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, and 2024 (Course 1.1.1, 1st Half).